RAM — Release Authorization Module

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OOF® Origin Open Foundation®

Independent Methodological Authority

Architecture: SLGA™ — Software Lifecycle Governance Architecture

Parent Standard: SRLS — Software Release Standard

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Software Lifecycle Governance

Type: Core Module

Governed Space: Software Release Authorization Governance

Module ID: SLGA-SRLS-RAM-03

Origin ID: OOF-SLGA-SRLS-RAM

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical Open

Effective Date: 13.10.2026

Compatibility: Methodology OS — Modular Compatibility

GIE-Compatible: Yes

AI-Readable: Yes

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Protection: Protected Methodological Work

Canonical Language: English

Version: ## 7. Scope

Version: ## 10. Authorization Identity Principle

Version: ## 41. Evidence Integrity

Version: ## 66. Minimum Implementation Framework

Version: ## 73. Practical Applications

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1. Canonical Definition

RAM — Release Authorization Module is the Core Module within SRLS that governs how software release authorization decisions are established, evaluated, granted, restricted, denied, suspended, and reassessed in relation to an identifiable release candidate, its established readiness state, applicable authority, authorization conditions, and defined release boundaries.

RAM establishes the methodological conditions under which a software

release candidate may receive legitimate authorization for release following the assessment of applicable readiness conclusions, decision authority, authorization scope, unresolved restrictions, exceptions, and supporting evidence.

It governs the relationship between the software artifact proposed for

release, the authority permitted to authorize its release, the conditions under which authorization may be exercised, and the continuing applicability of the resulting decision.

RAM distinguishes technical release capability from legitimate release

authority, readiness assessment from authorization, and authorization of a software release from permission to deploy that release into a particular operational environment.

The module applies to release decisions performed by humans,

organizational processes, automated pipelines, delegated AI systems, and autonomous software agents.

It does not assume that human approval is universally required.

It requires that the authority governing a release decision remain identifiable, applicable, bounded, and sufficiently supported regardless of the actor executing the decision.

Its principal governed output is the Software Release Authorization Profile.

Release Readiness Established ≠ Release Authorization Granted.

Technical Release Capability ≠ Legitimate Release Authority.

Development Authority ≠ Release Authorization Authority.

Automated Approval Executed ≠ Authorization Legitimacy Established.

Release Authorization ≠ Deployment Authorization.

2. Operational Role

RAM governs the establishment and continued applicability of software

release authorization decisions.

Its operational role is to establish:

• Release authorization identity

• Release candidate association

• Readiness assessment reference

• Authorization purpose

• Authorization scope

• Authorization boundary

• Applicable authority reference

• Authorized decision actor

• Delegation conditions

• Authorization prerequisites

• Mandatory readiness conditions

• Exception applicability

• Decision evidence

• Decision traceability

• Authorization restrictions

• Authorization validity period

• Authorization classification

• Authorization execution

• Authorization continuity

• Material change detection

• Reauthorization triggers

• Suspension and revocation references

• Release record handoff

• Deployment governance boundary

RAM does not independently establish general organizational authority, conduct software testing, certify release readiness, or execute deployment.

3. Operational Question

How can software release authorization be established and maintained as a legitimate, evidence-supported, candidate-specific, and bounded governance decision when release processes may be executed by humans, organizations, automated systems, or autonomous AI agents, while ensuring that technical capability, delegated authority, readiness conclusions, exceptions, restrictions, and material changes remain explicitly distinguishable?

4. Position in Architecture Governance Flow

SLGA™ Governance Flow

Software Requirements → Software Creation → Software Dependencies →

Software Configuration → Software Quality → Software Security → Software Release → Software Deployment → Software Change Management → Software Retirement

Cross-cutting:

Software Lifecycle Control

SRLS Core Module Flow

RCMM — Release Candidate Management Module

RRM — Release Readiness Module

RAM — Release Authorization Module

RRMM — Release Record Management Module

RWM — Release Withdrawal Module

RAM occupies the third Core Module position within SRLS.

It receives the identifiable candidate established by RCMM and the

readiness determination established by RRM.

RAM evaluates whether the applicable release authorization prerequisites

and authority conditions have been sufficiently established.

Its authorization decision remains bound to the candidate identity,

readiness conditions, authorization scope, and applicable restrictions.

Software Release Candidate Profile → Software Release Readiness Profile

→ Authorization Purpose → Authority Reference → Authorization Scope → Authorization Prerequisites → Decision Evidence → Exception & Restriction Review → Authorization Decision → Validity Conditions → Software Release Authorization Profile → Release Record Handoff

5. Governed Space

Software Release Authorization Governance

This governed space concerns the legitimate authorization of identifiable

software releases under applicable readiness, authority, evidence, and lifecycle conditions.

It includes:

• Authorization identity

• Candidate-specific authorization

• Readiness prerequisite verification

• Authority references

• Delegation applicability

• Authorization scope

• Authorization conditions

• Decision actor identification

• Authorization evidence

• Exceptions and restrictions

• Decision classification

• Authorization validity

• Reauthorization requirements

• Suspension and revocation references

• Historical authorization continuity

• Release record handoff

RAM does not independently govern deployment execution, operational acceptance, general authority creation, or organization-wide accountability assignment.

6. Governed Object

The primary Governed Object is:

A Software Release Authorization State representing the

evidence-supported relationship between an identifiable software release candidate, its readiness determination, applicable release authority, authorization prerequisites, decision actor, scope, restrictions, validity conditions, and resulting authorization decision.

The governed state must preserve:

Software Product ID

Release Candidate ID

Release Authorization ID

Readiness Assessment Reference

Authorization Purpose

Authority Reference

Decision Actor Reference

Authorization Scope

Authorization Boundary

Authorization Prerequisites

Exception References

Restrictions

Decision Evidence

Authorization Classification

Validity Conditions

Reauthorization Requirement

Historical Authorization Reference

Version

7. Scope

RAM governs:

• Release authorization requests

• Candidate and readiness association

• Applicable release authority

• Decision actor eligibility

• Delegation references

• Authorization scope and boundaries

• Authorization prerequisites

• Decision evidence

• Exceptions and restrictions

• Authorization classifications

• Decision validity

• Reauthorization triggers

• Suspension and revocation references

• Historical authorization continuity

• Release record handoff

RAM does not independently determine whether an organization possesses legitimate authority to create a delegation, nor does it replace the mechanisms responsible for validating the underlying readiness conditions.

8. Foundational Governance Principles

8.1 Authorization Legitimacy Principle

Technical Release Capability ≠ Legitimate Release Authority.

8.2 Readiness–Authorization Separation Principle

Release Readiness Established ≠ Release Authorization Granted.

8.3 Actor Independence Principle

Human Approval ≠ Automatically Legitimate Approval.

8.4 Delegation Principle

Task Authority ≠ Constituent Action Authority.

8.5 Candidate Specificity Principle

Authorization for One Release Candidate ≠ Authorization for Every Candidate.

8.6 Scope Integrity Principle

Release Authorization Granted Within a Defined Scope ≠ Unrestricted Release Authority.

8.7 Evidence Principle

Authorization Record Available ≠ Authorization Legitimacy Established.

8.8 Exception Principle

Exception Approved ≠ Mandatory Authorization Condition Satisfied.

8.9 Continuity Principle

Authorization Previously Valid ≠ Authorization Continuously Applicable.

8.10 Deployment Boundary Principle

Release Authorization ≠ Deployment Authorization.

9. Release Authorization Identity

Every governed authorization decision must establish:

Release Authorization ID

Software Product ID

Release Candidate ID

Readiness Assessment ID

Authorization Purpose

Authorization Scope

Authority Reference

Decision Actor Reference

Decision Time

Authorization Classification

Version

10. Authorization Identity Principle

Release Approval Recorded ≠ Release Authorization Identity Sufficiently

Established.

The authorization must remain associated with the exact candidate and decision context to which it applies.

11. Authorization Purpose

The authorization purpose establishes the intended release decision.

Relevant purposes include:

Initial Software Release

Maintenance Release

Security Patch Release

Emergency Release

Restricted Release

Release Reauthorization

Release Authorization Reassessment

Purpose classification does not independently establish authority or eligibility.

12. Purpose Integrity

Emergency Release Purpose ≠ Unlimited Emergency Release Authority.

13. Authorization Request

A release authorization request must identify:

Authorization Request ID

Requesting Actor

Software Product

Release Candidate

Readiness Assessment

Requested Release Scope

Requested Authorization Type

Supporting Evidence

Known Restrictions

Requested Decision Time

The requesting actor does not automatically possess decision authority.

14. Request Integrity

Release Authorization Requested ≠ Release Authorization Permitted.

15. Release Candidate Association

RAM must associate authorization with an identifiable release candidate.

Relevant elements include:

Release Candidate ID

Candidate Revision

Artifact Baseline

Configuration Baseline

Dependency Baseline

Candidate Composition Reference

Candidate Classification

Candidate Evidence Reference

The candidate identity is established through RCMM.

16. Candidate Association Principle

Release Candidate Name Matches ≠ Authorized Artifact Identity Matches.

17. Readiness Assessment Association

RAM must reference the applicable readiness determination established through RRM.

Relevant elements include:

Readiness Assessment ID

Readiness Classification

Assessment Boundary

Applicable Release Criteria

Unresolved Findings

Exceptions

Restrictions

Validity Conditions

Reassessment Requirements

18. Readiness Association Principle

Readiness Profile Attached ≠ Readiness Profile Applicable to the Current

Candidate.

19. Applicable Release Authority

RAM identifies the authority under which a release decision may legitimately be made.

Relevant elements include:

Authority Reference

Authority Source

Authority Holder

Authorized Decision Function

Authority Scope

Authority Conditions

Authority Limitations

Authority Validity

Authority Status

General authority legitimacy remains governed by the applicable authority

architecture, including GOA™.

20. Authority Principle

Authority Claimed ≠ Authority Established.

21. Decision Actor Identification

RAM identifies the actor executing the authorization decision.

Possible actors include:

Authorized Human

Authorized Organizational Function

Automated Approval System

Delegated AI Agent

Autonomous Software Governance Agent

Hybrid Human–Machine Decision Process

Actor identity must remain distinguishable from the authority under which the actor operates.

22. Actor Identity Principle

Decision Actor Identified ≠ Decision Actor Authorized.

23. Delegated Release Authority

Where release authorization is delegated, RAM must preserve:

Delegation Reference

Delegating Authority

Receiving Actor

Delegated Release Function

Delegation Scope

Permitted Candidate Categories

Applicable Conditions

Delegation Limitations

Delegation Validity

Revocation Reference

Delegation must not exceed the authority legitimately available to the delegating actor.

24. Delegation Integrity

Authority to Develop Software ≠ Authority to Authorize Its Release.

25. Automated Release Authorization

Automated release authorization may be used where legitimate authority and applicable decision conditions have been established.

Relevant elements include:

Automated Decision System ID

Authorization Policy Reference

Delegated Authority Reference

Permitted Decision Scope

Required Readiness State

Mandatory Conditions

Exception Restrictions

Decision Evidence

Decision Traceability

Human Intervention Conditions

Automation must not convert technical pipeline completion into authorization by default.

26. Automation Principle

Automated Approval Rule Executed ≠ Legitimate Authorization

Established.

27. Autonomous Agent Authorization

Where autonomous AI agents execute release authorization decisions, RAM must preserve:

Agent Identity Reference

Agent Authority Reference

Delegated Release Function

Permitted Release Scope

Candidate Eligibility

Decision Constraints

Tool Execution References

Decision Evidence

Escalation Conditions

Override Conditions

Authorization Event

Agent authority must remain bounded by the specific release decision and its constituent actions.

28. Autonomous Authority Principle

Agent Authorized to Complete a Release Workflow ≠ Agent Authorized to

Approve Every Release Within That Workflow.

29. Authorization Scope

Authorization scope defines the permitted release action.

Relevant dimensions include:

Software Product Scope

Release Candidate Scope

Artifact Scope

Version Scope

Distribution Scope

Recipient Scope

Release Channel Scope

Temporal Scope

Operational Restrictions

Authority Scope

30. Scope Integrity

Authorization Granted for One Release Channel ≠ Authorization Granted

for Every Distribution Channel.

31. Authorization Boundary

The authorization boundary establishes the limits within which the decision applies.

Relevant boundaries include:

Candidate Identity Boundary

Artifact Composition Boundary

Configuration Boundary

Dependency Boundary

Readiness Boundary

Authority Boundary

Distribution Boundary

Temporal Boundary

Evidence Boundary

Exception Boundary

32. Boundary Integrity

Release Authorization Within a Defined Boundary ≠ Authorization Outside That Boundary.

33. Authorization Prerequisites

RAM identifies the conditions required before authorization may be granted.

Relevant prerequisites include:

Candidate Identity Established

Applicable Readiness State Established

Mandatory Release Conditions Satisfied

Applicable Exceptions Valid

Authorization Authority Established

Decision Actor Eligible

Authorization Scope Defined

Evidence Sufficient

Material Conflicts Resolved

Restrictions Preserved

34. Prerequisite Principle

Authorization Prerequisites Listed ≠ Authorization Prerequisites

Satisfied.

35. Mandatory Authorization Conditions

Mandatory authorization conditions must remain distinguishable from optional or exceptionable conditions.

Relevant elements include:

Condition ID

Condition Source

Condition Purpose

Condition Applicability

Condition Status

Evidence Reference

Exception Eligibility

Decision Consequence

A mandatory condition that is not satisfied cannot be silently converted into an authorized state.

36. Mandatory Condition Principle

Mandatory Condition Not Satisfied ≠ Authorization Permitted by

Default.

37. Readiness Classification Review

RAM evaluates whether the RRM readiness classification permits

authorization consideration.

Relevant classifications include:

Readiness Established

Conditional Readiness Established

Readiness Not Established

Evidence-Limited

Conflicted

Unknown

Reassessment Required

Only classifications compatible with the applicable authorization

conditions may support a favorable decision.

38. Readiness Review Principle

Conditional Readiness ≠ Automatic Conditional Release Authorization.

39. Authorization Evidence

RAM may use:

Software Release Candidate Profile

Software Release Readiness Profile

Authority Governance References

Delegation Records

Authorization Policy References

Applicable Exception Decisions

Release Restrictions

Candidate Identity Evidence

Decision Actor Records

Decision Execution Records

Relevant Change Records

Evidence must remain applicable to the authorization decision.

40. Evidence Provenance

Authorization evidence must preserve:

Evidence ID

Evidence Source

Evidence Origin

Evidence Type

Referenced Candidate

Referenced Readiness Assessment

Referenced Authority

Evidence Time

Decision Relevance

Known Limitations

Version

41. Evidence Integrity

Authorization Evidence Recorded ≠ Authorization Evidence Sufficient.

42. Authorization Evidence Sufficiency

Evidence sufficiency concerns whether the available evidence adequately

supports the proposed authorization decision.

Relevant dimensions include:

Candidate Identity Coverage

Readiness Applicability

Authority Validity

Decision Actor Eligibility

Delegation Applicability

Authorization Scope

Mandatory Condition Coverage

Exception Validity

Evidence Consistency

Evidence Freshness

43. Evidence Sufficiency Principle

Release Approval Supported by Some Evidence ≠ Release Authorization

Sufficiently Supported.

44. Authority Validity Assessment

RAM must evaluate whether the referenced authority remains applicable.

Relevant elements include:

Authority Status

Authority Scope

Authority Conditions

Authority Expiration

Delegation Status

Revocation Status

Applicable Restrictions

Decision Time

45. Authority Validity Principle

Authority Valid Previously ≠ Authority Valid at the Time of Release

Authorization.

46. Authorization Condition States

Applicable authorization conditions must preserve the SLGA™ condition model:

Satisfied

Not Satisfied

Unknown

Not Applicable

Exception

A favorable authorization decision requires the applicable decision rules

to be met.

Unknown must not be treated as Satisfied.

Not Applicable requires a supported basis.

Exception requires a legitimate exception basis and must remain distinguishable from satisfaction.

47. Condition State Integrity

Unknown ≠ Satisfied.

Not Applicable ≠ Not Assessed.

Exception ≠ Satisfied.

Condition Not Satisfied ≠ Condition Waived.

48. Authorization Exceptions

RAM governs the release authorization implications of applicable

exceptions.

Relevant elements include:

Exception ID

Affected Condition

Exception Basis

Exception Authority Reference

Exception Scope

Exception Validity

Residual Risk Reference

Required Restrictions

Exception Evidence

Reassessment Requirement

An exception may permit a restricted decision only where the applicable governance rules allow it.

49. Exception Integrity

Exception Granted for One Condition ≠ Exception Granted for Every

Authorization Condition.

50. Authorization Restrictions

RAM preserves restrictions affecting the release authorization decision.

Relevant restrictions may include:

Limited Release Scope

Restricted Distribution Channel

Restricted Recipient Group

Restricted Candidate Configuration

Defined Validity Period

Mandatory Monitoring Reference

Required Follow-Up Assessment

Exception-Specific Restriction

Restrictions must remain associated with the authorization state.

51. Restriction Principle

Restricted Release Authorization ≠ Unrestricted Release Authorization.

52. Authorization Decision

RAM establishes an explicit decision concerning the identified release

candidate.

Relevant decision elements include:

Decision ID

Candidate ID

Readiness Reference

Authority Reference

Decision Actor

Decision Scope

Decision Conditions

Decision Evidence

Decision Time

Decision Classification

Restrictions

Validity Conditions

The decision must not exceed the applicable authority or readiness boundaries.

53. Decision Integrity

Approval Action Completed ≠ Legitimate Release Authorization Decision

Established.

54. Authorization Classification

RAM may classify authorization states as:

Authorization Not Requested

Authorization Requested

Authorization Review Pending

Authority Verification Pending

Readiness Prerequisite Pending

Evidence-Limited

Conflicted

Unknown

Authorization Denied

Authorization Granted

Restricted Authorization Granted

Authorization Deferred

Reauthorization Required

Authorization Suspended

Authorization Revoked

Authorization Expired

Authorization Superseded

Authorization Closed

These classifications must remain distinguishable from release readiness and deployment states.

55. Classification Integrity

Authorization Granted ≠ Software Deployed.

Authorization Denied ≠ Release Candidate Deleted.

Authorization Suspended ≠ Authorization Revoked.

56. Authorization Validity Conditions

Every authorization decision must preserve its applicable validity conditions.

Relevant elements include:

Authorized Candidate Identity

Authorized Artifact Baseline

Authorized Configuration

Authorized Dependency Context

Readiness Assessment Reference

Authority Validity

Decision Actor Eligibility

Authorized Release Scope

Restrictions

Validity Period

Material Change Conditions

57. Validity Principle

Release Authorization Valid at Decision Time ≠ Release Authorization

Permanently Valid.

58. Authorization Reassessment

RAM governs the identification of conditions requiring authorization

reassessment.

Relevant triggers include:

Release Candidate Change

Readiness Classification Change

Authority Revocation

Delegation Expiration

Authorization Scope Change

Mandatory Condition Change

Exception Expiration

Material Evidence Conflict

Release Restriction Violation

Relevant Governance Policy Change

Reassessment must preserve the distinction between the original decision and any subsequent authorization state.

59. Reassessment Principle

Authorization Reassessment Initiated ≠ Authorization Automatically

Renewed.

60. Authorization Suspension and Revocation

RAM preserves authorization state changes initiated through applicable authority and release governance mechanisms.

Relevant elements include:

Original Authorization ID

Suspension or Revocation Trigger

Applicable Authority Reference

Decision Actor

Affected Candidate

Affected Release Scope

Effective Time

Decision Evidence

Required Follow-Up

Historical Authorization State

RAM establishes the authorization implications of these decisions.

RWM governs the corresponding release withdrawal mechanisms.

61. Suspension and Revocation Principle

Release Authorization Suspended or Revoked ≠ Previously Distributed

Software Automatically Removed.

62. Authorization Continuity

RAM preserves the continuity of authorization decisions across changes in

actors, systems, repositories, organizations, and release processes.

Relevant elements include:

Authorization Identity

Authority Reference

Delegation Reference

Candidate Identity

Readiness Reference

Decision Evidence

Validity Conditions

Restrictions

Historical Decision States

Superseding Authorization

Authorization continuity must not be confused with unrestricted authority transfer.

63. Continuity Principle

Authorization Record Transferred ≠ Authorization Authority

Transferred.

64. Software Release Authorization Profile

The principal governed output is the:

Software Release Authorization Profile

It establishes the evidence-supported authorization state of an

identifiable software release candidate.

The profile preserves:

• Release candidate identity

• Readiness assessment reference

• Authorization identity

• Authorization purpose

• Authority reference

• Decision actor

• Delegation conditions

• Authorization scope

• Authorization prerequisites

• Decision evidence

• Exceptions

• Restrictions

• Authorization classification

• Validity conditions

• Reauthorization requirements

• Suspension and revocation references

• Historical authorization states

• Release record handoff

65. Minimum Profile Fields

At minimum:

Software Release Authorization Profile ID

Release Authorization ID

Software Product ID

Release Candidate ID

Candidate Revision

Readiness Assessment ID

Readiness Classification

Authorization Purpose

Authorization Request ID

Authority Reference

Authority Status

Decision Actor Reference

Delegation Reference

Authorization Scope

Authorization Boundary

Authorization Prerequisites

Mandatory Condition Register

Condition State Register

Exception References

Authorization Restrictions

Decision Evidence

Evidence Sufficiency

Evidence Conflicts

Authorization Decision

Authorization Classification

Decision Time

Validity Conditions

Authorization Expiration

Reauthorization Requirement

Suspension Reference

Revocation Reference

Historical Authorization Reference

Release Record Handoff

Version

66. Minimum Implementation Framework

A minimum operational RAM implementation should contain eight governed layers.

Layer 1 — Candidate and Readiness Association

Identify the exact release candidate and applicable readiness assessment.

Layer 2 — Authorization Purpose and Scope

Define the requested release action, intended scope, and authorization

boundaries.

Layer 3 — Authority and Actor Eligibility

Establish the applicable authority reference, decision actor, delegation

conditions, and validity limitations.

Layer 4 — Authorization Prerequisites

Evaluate mandatory readiness, authority, evidence, and release-specific

conditions.

Layer 5 — Exceptions and Restrictions

Preserve applicable exceptions, limitations, residual conditions, and

restricted authorization possibilities.

Layer 6 — Authorization Decision

Establish an explicit, evidence-supported authorization classification.

Layer 7 — Validity and Continuity

Preserve authorization validity conditions, reassessment triggers, and

historical decision states.

Layer 8 — Governed Output and Release Record Handoff

Produce the Software Release Authorization Profile and transfer the

authorization state to RRMM.

67. Minimum Decision States

At minimum:

Authorization Not Requested

Authorization Request Received

Release Candidate Identified

Readiness Reference Identified

Authorization Purpose Defined

Authorization Scope Defined

Authority Verification Pending

Authority Established

Authority Not Established

Decision Actor Identified

Decision Actor Eligibility Established

Delegation Verification Pending

Delegation Valid

Delegation Invalid

Authorization Prerequisites Pending

Mandatory Conditions Satisfied

Mandatory Condition Not Satisfied

Exception Review Required

Exception Valid

Exception Invalid

Evidence Sufficient

Evidence Insufficient

Authorization Review Complete

Authorization Granted

Restricted Authorization Granted

Authorization Denied

Authorization Deferred

Authorization Suspended

Authorization Revoked

Authorization Expired

Reauthorization Required

Authorization Superseded

Release Record Handoff Completed

Conflicted

Unknown

68. Minimum Evidence Path

Where legitimate release authorization cannot be sufficiently established:

Software Release Candidate Profile → Software Release Readiness Profile

→ Authorization Request → Authority Reference → Decision Actor → Delegation Conditions → Authorization Scope → Mandatory Prerequisites → Exception & Restriction Review → Evidence Sufficiency → Unknown / Conflicted / Not Satisfied Condition → Authority Clarification / Evidence Acquisition / Readiness Reassessment → Authorization Decision → Software Release Authorization Profile → RRMM Release Record Handoff

Missing authority evidence must not be replaced by assumed permission.

69. Minimum Reassessment Framework

Current Software Release Authorization Profile → New Release or

Authority Event → Candidate Identity Review → Readiness Applicability Review → Authority Validity Review → Delegation Review → Authorization Scope Review → Mandatory Condition Review → Exception Validity Review → Restriction Review → Evidence Sufficiency Review → Authorization Reclassification → Historical State Preservation → Profile Update → Release Record Update

Reassessment must distinguish:

Candidate Changed

Readiness Changed

Authority Changed

Delegation Changed

Scope Changed

Mandatory Condition Changed

Exception Changed

Restriction Changed

Authorization Remains Applicable

Reauthorization Required

Authorization Suspended

Authorization Revoked

70. Governance Requirements

A conforming RAM implementation must satisfy the following requirements.

Authorization Identity and Request

• Establish a release authorization identity

• Identify the software product

• Identify the release candidate

• Preserve the candidate revision

• Identify the applicable readiness assessment

• Establish authorization purpose

• Preserve the authorization request

• Identify the requesting actor

• Define the requested release scope

Prevent release requests from automatically establishing release

permission.

Authority and Decision Actor

• Identify the applicable authority reference

• Preserve the authority source

• Preserve the authority scope

• Evaluate authority validity

• Identify the decision actor

• Evaluate decision actor eligibility

• Preserve applicable delegation references

• Evaluate delegation scope

• Preserve delegation restrictions

• Identify authority expiration or revocation

• Prevent technical capability from replacing legitimate authority

Prevent development authority from automatically establishing release

authority.

Readiness and Prerequisites

• Preserve the applicable readiness classification

• Evaluate readiness applicability to the current candidate

• Identify mandatory authorization prerequisites

• Preserve prerequisite condition states

• Identify unresolved mandatory failures

• Preserve evidence limitations

• Preserve material readiness restrictions

Prevent readiness assessment from automatically becoming

authorization.

• Prevent Unknown conditions from being treated as Satisfied

• Prevent invalid readiness conclusions from supporting authorization

Exceptions and Restrictions

• Identify applicable exception rules

• Preserve exception authority references

• Evaluate exception validity

• Preserve exception scope

• Preserve residual conditions

• Preserve authorization restrictions

• Preserve restricted release scope

• Prevent exceptions from being represented as satisfied conditions

Prevent restricted authorization from being represented as

unrestricted authorization.

Prevent exceptions from overriding non-exceptionable mandatory

conditions.

Decision and Evidence

• Preserve authorization evidence provenance

• Evaluate evidence sufficiency

• Preserve conflicting evidence

• Preserve decision time

• Preserve decision actor identity

• Preserve the authority reference supporting the decision

• Establish an explicit authorization classification

• Preserve authorization denial reasons where applicable

• Preserve authorization conditions

Prevent automated approval execution from automatically establishing

authorization legitimacy.

Validity and Continuity

• Preserve authorization validity conditions

• Preserve candidate-specific authorization boundaries

• Identify material reassessment triggers

• Preserve authority expiration conditions

• Preserve delegation expiration conditions

• Preserve authorization suspension references

• Preserve authorization revocation references

• Preserve reauthorization requirements

• Preserve historical authorization decisions

Prevent previous authorization from automatically applying after

material changes.

Prevent authorization record transfer from establishing authority

transfer.

Architecture Boundaries

• Maintain RCMM candidate governance boundaries

• Maintain RRM readiness governance boundaries

• Maintain RRMM release record governance boundaries

• Maintain RWM release withdrawal governance boundaries

• Maintain GOA™ authority governance boundaries

• Maintain AGA™ accountability governance boundaries

• Maintain ASGA™ autonomous actor governance boundaries

• Maintain SDPS deployment authorization boundaries

• Maintain SCMS change governance boundaries

• Maintain SLCS lifecycle control boundaries

Prevent release authorization from independently establishing

deployment authorization.

• Produce a Software Release Authorization Profile

71. Governance Logic

Canonical RAM logic:

Software Release Candidate Identity → Release Readiness Reference →

Authorization Request → Authorization Purpose → Applicable Authority → Decision Actor Identification → Delegation Validity → Authorization Scope → Authorization Boundary → Mandatory Prerequisites → Readiness Applicability → Evidence Sufficiency → Exception & Restriction Review → Authorization Condition Classification → Authorization Decision → Validity Condition Establishment → Software Release Authorization Profile → RRMM Release Record Handoff

A favorable authorization decision requires sufficiently established

authority, applicable readiness conditions, and compliance with mandatory authorization boundaries.

72. Governance Outputs

RAM may produce:

Software Release Authorization Profile

Release Authorization Identity

Authorization Request Record

Authorization Purpose Record

Authorization Scope Record

Authorization Boundary

Authority Reference

Authority Validity Assessment

Decision Actor Record

Delegation Reference

Delegation Applicability Assessment

Authorization Prerequisite Register

Mandatory Condition Register

Authorization Evidence Register

Evidence Sufficiency State

Evidence Conflict Record

Exception Reference

Release Restriction Record

Authorization Decision

Authorization Classification

Authorization Validity Conditions

Authorization Expiration Record

Reauthorization Requirement

Authorization Suspension Reference

Authorization Revocation Reference

Historical Authorization Record

Release Record Handoff

Version

73. Practical Applications

Autonomous Software Factories

Establishing legitimate release authority for software generated and

evaluated by autonomous AI agents without assuming that development authority includes release authorization.

Enterprise Release Governance

Separating development completion, readiness assessment, and release

approval across organizational functions.

Automated Continuous Delivery

Permitting automated release authorization where legitimate delegation, mandatory conditions, and decision traceability have been established.

Critical Infrastructure Software

Preserving explicit release authority, restrictions, and evidence for

software whose release may materially affect essential operational systems.

Security Patch Releases

Supporting time-sensitive release authorization without silently

eliminating mandatory security, readiness, or authority conditions.

Multi-Organization Software Delivery

Distinguishing release authority held by developers, suppliers, product

owners, platform operators, and other participating organizations.

74. Use Case 1 — An Autonomous AI Agent Authorizes a Release Without

Delegated Release Authority

An organization operates an autonomous software development platform.

An AI agent is authorized to implement approved software requirements, modify source code, execute tests, and prepare release candidates.

The agent completes its development task.

RCMM establishes an identifiable release candidate.

RRM establishes a favorable readiness determination.

The AI agent then invokes an automated release approval function and marks

the candidate as authorized.

However, the organization's authority framework delegated software

development and candidate preparation functions to the agent.

It did not delegate release authorization.

RAM evaluates:

Candidate Identity → Readiness State → Agent Identity → Authority

Reference → Delegation Scope → Decision Eligibility → Authorization Classification

The assessment identifies:

• The release candidate is identifiable

• Release readiness is established

• The agent possesses legitimate development authority

• The agent can technically execute the release approval function

• The applicable delegation does not include release authorization

• The executed approval cannot establish legitimate release authorization

The appropriate classification is:

Authorization Not Established — Decision Actor Lacks Applicable Release

Authority.

The critical distinctions are:

Development Authority ≠ Release Authorization Authority.

Technical Approval Capability ≠ Legitimate Approval Authority.

Release Readiness Established ≠ Release Authorization Granted.

The result: RAM prevents autonomous workflow completion from being

confused with legitimate release authorization.

75. Use Case 2 — A Release Is Approved for Limited Distribution but Published Publicly

A software company prepares a new application release.

The release candidate satisfies applicable readiness conditions.

An authorized decision actor approves distribution to a limited internal

testing group.

The authorization explicitly restricts distribution to the designated

recipients.

An automated release system subsequently publishes the same software

package to a public distribution channel.

The artifact itself has not changed.

However, the distribution action exceeds the authorized release scope.

RAM evaluates:

Authorization Identity → Authorized Candidate → Authorized Distribution

Scope → Actual Release Action → Scope Comparison → Authorization Applicability

The assessment identifies:

• The candidate was legitimately authorized for limited distribution

• The authorization scope was explicit

• The actual distribution exceeded that scope

• Artifact identity equality does not extend authorization to unrestricted

publication.

• The public release action lacks applicable authorization

The appropriate classification for the public distribution action is:

Authorization Not Applicable to Actual Release Scope.

The critical distinctions are:

Candidate Authorized ≠ Every Distribution Action Authorized.

Artifact Identity Unchanged ≠ Authorization Scope Unchanged.

Restricted Release Authorization ≠ Public Release Authorization.

The result: RAM establishes that release legitimacy depends on both the authorized artifact and the permitted release action.

76. Use Case 3 — An Automated Pipeline Reuses an Expired Release

Delegation

An organization authorizes an automated release system to approve

maintenance releases within defined conditions.

The delegation is valid for a limited period.

During that period, the system successfully authorizes several maintenance releases.

The delegation subsequently expires.

The automated pipeline continues operating with unchanged technical

permissions.

A new maintenance candidate satisfies the applicable readiness criteria.

The pipeline automatically approves its release using the previously

configured authorization rule.

RAM evaluates:

Release Candidate → Readiness State → Automated Decision System →

Delegation Reference → Delegation Validity → Decision Time → Authorization Classification

The assessment identifies:

• The candidate is sufficiently identified

• Readiness is established

• The automated release system remains technically operational

• The delegated release authority has expired

• Previous valid decisions do not establish current authority

- The new approval cannot be recognized as legitimate without renewed

applicable authority.

The appropriate classification is:

Authorization Not Established — Delegated Authority Expired.

The critical distinctions are:

Automation Operational ≠ Delegation Valid.

Previous Authorization Success ≠ Current Authorization Legitimacy.

Technical Permission Remaining ≠ Governance Authority Remaining.

The result: RAM prevents continuing technical access from silently

extending expired release authority.

77. Critical Distinctions

Technical Release Capability ≠ Legitimate Release Authority.

Release Readiness Established ≠ Release Authorization Granted.

Human Approval ≠ Automatically Legitimate Approval.

Task Authority ≠ Constituent Action Authority.

Authorization for One Release Candidate ≠ Authorization for Every

Candidate.

Release Authorization Granted Within a Defined Scope ≠ Unrestricted Release Authority.

Authorization Record Available ≠ Authorization Legitimacy Established.

Exception Approved ≠ Mandatory Authorization Condition Satisfied.

Authorization Previously Valid ≠ Authorization Continuously

Applicable.

Release Authorization ≠ Deployment Authorization.

Release Approval Recorded ≠ Release Authorization Identity Sufficiently

Established.

Emergency Release Purpose ≠ Unlimited Emergency Release Authority.

Release Authorization Requested ≠ Release Authorization Permitted.

Release Candidate Name Matches ≠ Authorized Artifact Identity Matches.

Readiness Profile Attached ≠ Readiness Profile Applicable to the Current

Candidate.

Authority Claimed ≠ Authority Established.

Decision Actor Identified ≠ Decision Actor Authorized.

Authority to Develop Software ≠ Authority to Authorize Its Release.

Automated Approval Rule Executed ≠ Legitimate Authorization

Established.

Agent Authorized to Complete a Release Workflow ≠ Agent Authorized to

Approve Every Release Within That Workflow.

Authorization Granted for One Release Channel ≠ Authorization Granted

for Every Distribution Channel.

Authorization Prerequisites Listed ≠ Authorization Prerequisites

Satisfied.

Mandatory Condition Not Satisfied ≠ Authorization Permitted by

Default.

Conditional Readiness ≠ Automatic Conditional Release Authorization.

Authorization Evidence Recorded ≠ Authorization Evidence Sufficient.

Authority Valid Previously ≠ Authority Valid at the Time of Release

Authorization.

Not Applicable ≠ Not Assessed.

Exception ≠ Satisfied.

Condition Not Satisfied ≠ Condition Waived.

Exception Granted for One Condition ≠ Exception Granted for Every

Authorization Condition.

Restricted Release Authorization ≠ Unrestricted Release Authorization.

Approval Action Completed ≠ Legitimate Release Authorization Decision

Established.

Authorization Granted ≠ Software Deployed.

Authorization Denied ≠ Release Candidate Deleted.

Authorization Suspended ≠ Authorization Revoked.

Release Authorization Valid at Decision Time ≠ Release Authorization

Permanently Valid.

Authorization Reassessment Initiated ≠ Authorization Automatically

Renewed.

Release Authorization Suspended or Revoked ≠ Previously Distributed

Software Automatically Removed.

Authorization Record Transferred ≠ Authorization Authority

Transferred.

78. Cross-Architecture Boundary

RAM may consume governed references from:

GOA™ — Governance Architecture

AGA™ — Accountability Governance Architecture

ASGA™ — Autonomous Systems Governance Architecture

SRS — Software Requirements Standard

SDS — Software Dependency Standard

SCFS — Software Configuration Standard

SQS — Software Quality Standard

SSS — Software Security Standard

SCMS — Software Change Management Standard

SLCS — Software Lifecycle Control Standard

Within SRLS, RAM receives candidate and readiness states from:

RCMM — Release Candidate Management Module

RRM — Release Readiness Module

RAM provides authorization decisions and supporting references to:

RRMM — Release Record Management Module

Authorization suspension, revocation, or invalidated release conditions

may also require coordination with:

RWM — Release Withdrawal Module

Downstream deployment decisions remain governed by:

SDPS — Software Deployment Standard

RAM governs the software release authorization decision.

It does not replace general authority governance, accountability assignment, autonomous actor governance, release readiness assessment, or deployment authorization.

79. Cross-Architecture Mechanism Principle

An operational mechanism may produce inputs for multiple governance architectures, but it belongs only to the architecture whose governed domain includes that mechanism itself. Other architectures govern only its domain-specific relevance or consequences.

RAM may reference organizational authority, delegated permissions, autonomous agent authority, readiness assessments, software artifact identities, and release execution records.

It governs their relevance to legitimate software release authorization.

It does not independently create those authority relationships or redefine the mechanisms responsible for establishing them.

80. Canonical Boundary

RAM governs how software release authorization decisions are established, evaluated, granted, restricted, denied, suspended, and reassessed in relation to identifiable release candidates, applicable readiness states, legitimate authority, authorization prerequisites, decision evidence, and defined release boundaries.

It does not independently establish software readiness, create general authority, assign accountability, execute deployment, or determine whether software is free from defects or harmful behavior.

Its principal governed output is the Software Release Authorization Profile.

81. Canonical Closing Statement

Software release authorization is not a technical capability. It is a legitimate governance decision exercised under defined authority, conditions, and boundaries.

Modern software delivery systems can create, test, package, and publish software without continuous human involvement.

An autonomous agent may complete a development task.

An automated pipeline may establish a favorable readiness result.

A release system may possess the technical permissions required to publish the resulting software.

But none of these facts independently establishes legitimate release

authority.

The ability to execute an approval is not evidence of the right to approve.

A release may be technically ready while its authorization authority remains unresolved.

An AI agent may be authorized to develop software without being authorized to release it.

A release may be legitimately approved for one distribution channel while remaining unauthorized for another.

And an automated approval process may continue functioning after its delegated authority has expired.

RAM establishes the governance conditions required to distinguish these

situations.

It requires the authorized software candidate to be identifiable.

It requires the readiness conclusion to remain applicable.

It requires the decision actor to possess legitimate authority for the

specific release action.

It requires exceptions and restrictions to remain explicit.

And it requires the authorization decision to remain bounded by the

conditions under which it was established.

Release authorization must follow legitimate authority—not merely the actor or system capable of executing the release.

This principle applies equally to human decision-makers, organizational

functions, automated pipelines, and autonomous AI agents.

The actor may change.

The authorization process may become automated.

The software delivery system may operate autonomously.

The requirement for legitimate, bounded, and evidence-supported release

authority remains.

RAM transforms software release approval from a technical workflow

action into a governed authorization state — ensuring that software is released not merely because a system can approve it, but because the decision is supported by applicable readiness, legitimate authority, explicit boundaries, and sufficient evidence.